

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6
 ♥ 9 7 3
 ♦ A Q 8 2
 ♣ 7 5 3 2

♠ J 8 4

♥ A 2

♦ K T 9 6 3

♣ K J 4



♠ A K 7 3 2

♥ 8 6 4

♦ J 5

♣ T 9 8

♠ Q T 5

♥ K Q J T 5

♦ 7 4

♣ A Q 6

After South's 1♥ opening North counts 12 HCP plus one length point for the fifth ♦. That is enough for a 2/1 response so North says 2♦. The partnership is now forced to reach game so South bids 2NT. This describes a balanced hand with exactly 5♥s and no 4-card ♠ suit. What should you bid now? North is happy to play in Notrump, and with no extra strength above the 13 points already promised, uses Quick Arrival and bids 3NT. South passes and a reasonable game contract is reached. Notice that you would bid this hand the same way whether or not you play 2/1.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9 2

♥ T 7 6

♦ 7 2

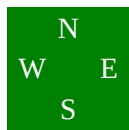
♣ 9 7 5 2

♠ K J 8

♥ A 2

♦ K T 9 6 3

♣ K J 4



♠ T 7 4 3

♥ 9 5

♦ Q J 8 4

♣ A T 8

♠ 6 5

♥ K Q J 8 4 3

♦ A 5

♣ Q 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

South opens 1♥. With 16 points, you respond 2♦, forcing the partnership to game. South rebids 2♥. In our style of 2/1 this promises a 6th heart. What do you rebid now?

Opposite South's 6-card suit, your doubleton is adequate support. If you had a minimum for your 2/1 response you might just jump to 4♥ to show no interest in slam. With a little extra you bid 3♥ since she knows the bidding cannot stop until game is reached. From your perspective South might have a big hand; his 2-level rebid shows suit length but does not say anything about strength. This is one of the beauties of 2/1, the bidding can be kept low while you look for the best place to play. However, this time South merely bids the game and you pass.

The hand is harder to bid in standard bidding - you couldn't bid 3♥ to show slam interest.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A T 9 7 4

♥ T

♦ J 9 4

♣ J T 9 5

♠ Q 6

♥ A 8 2

♦ A K Q 6 3

♣ 7 6 3



♠ J 8 3 2

♥ 9 6 5

♦ T 8 2

♣ Q 8 2

♠ K 5

♥ K Q J 7 4 3

♦ 7 5

♣ A K 4

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

How do you respond with this nice hand? With 16+ points and 3 ♥s, you will insist on a ♥ game at a minimum. But there is no need to start making jump bids, so start with a simple 2♦ bid. This is natural and game forcing. South rebids 2♥ to show a 6-card suit. What do you rebid now? Now you say 3♥ to set the trump suit, and show slam interest. At this point South also shows slam interest, making a control-showing bid of 4♣. Do you cooperate? Yes, you have an easy, 4♦ bid, showing the ♦ A. South has heard enough. He bids 4NT. What do you respond, playing standard Blackwood?

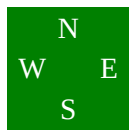
When partner hears about your two aces, he bids the slam.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9	♠ Q	♠ T 7 4 3 2
♥ Q T	♥ A 9 8 6 5	♥ K J 7 2
♦ A K J T 8 4 3	♦ 9 6 2	♦ Q
♣ Q T 8	♣ A 7 4 2	♣ J 9 5
	♠ A K J 8 6 5	
	♥ 4 3	
	♦ 7 5	
	♣ K 6 3	



South opens 1♠. West overcalls 2♦. After West's 2♦ overcall both South and North know that the 2/1 Game Force is no longer on. North can therefore bid 2♥, showing at least 11 points. This bid is forcing on South for 1 round, but not forcing to game. South next rebids his ♠s, promising a 6-card suit, but also indicating a minimum strength hand. Since the Game Force is not on, South would have to make a jump bid to show extra strength.

You have nothing further to say so the partnership arrives in a safe contract.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
2♦	2♥	Pass	2♠
All Pass			
2♠ by South			

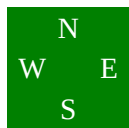
Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 2
 ♥ J 9 2
 ♦ T 8 4 3 2
 ♣ K Q 3

♠ Q 4
 ♥ Q T 7
 ♦ A J 6
 ♣ A T 9 8 6



♠ A 8 7 3
 ♥ 6 5
 ♦ K Q 9
 ♣ J 7 5 2

♠ K J 9 6 5
 ♥ A K 8 4 3
 ♦ 7 5
 ♣ 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

South opens 1 ♠. So far you know you belong in game, but you don't know which game. What do you bid first? You respond 2 ♣, natural and forcing the partnership to game. South now bids his ♥ suit. At this point you figure South for 5 ♠s and 4 ♥s. What should you rebid? You cannot support either of South's Majors, but with a good stopper in the fourth suit you bid 2NT. The game force is still on and South may not pass this bid. South bids 3 ♥, indicating that this is also a 5-card suit. What do you rebid now?

Now you can bid the ♥ game, knowing there is an 8-card fit.

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q
 ♥ J 8 4
 ♦ J T 2
 ♣ K J T 5 4 3

♠ A J T 7 4

♥ K T 7

♦ A 9 5

♣ 7 2



♠ K 9 8 3 2

♥ 6 2

♦ 8 7 4

♣ A 8 6

♠ 6 5

♥ A Q 9 5 3

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ Q 9

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

What do you open with this hand? You opens 1 ♠ and South, responds 2 ♥. Note that this promises a 5-card or longer ♥ suit. (2 of a minor only promises 4+). What do you rebid? Knowing that South has 5, you bid 3 ♥ to confirm the trump suit. South bids 4 ♥.

South went straight to game, showing a minimum opener and no slam interest. You are also satisfied to just play at game.

2/1 is a good bidding method, and here, 4 ♥ is a good contract. But you can see that it is not a laydown - there is no bidding system that will always reach 100% contracts. In this hand a 3-3 ♦ split will provide the 10th trick, or if that fails, taking 2 ♠ finesses provides a 75% chance of success.